

Fire Emergency Response SOP

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1. Purpose

This SOP establishes the response procedure for fire emergencies within the facility to protect life, minimize property damage, and ensure an organized, rapid response by employees, the fire warden team, and external emergency services.

2. Scope

Applies to all employees, contractors, and visitors present at the facility at the time of a fire or suspected fire, including small incipient fires and full structural fire events.

3. Immediate Response on Discovering a Fire

- Activate the nearest manual call point / fire alarm immediately.
- Alert nearby personnel by shouting 'FIRE' and the location.
- If the fire is small (incipient stage, roughly the size of a wastebasket) and you are trained, attempt to extinguish it using the appropriate fire extinguisher, keeping an unobstructed escape route behind you at all times.
- If the fire is spreading, producing heavy smoke, or you are not confident in extinguishing it safely, evacuate immediately and close doors behind you to slow fire spread without locking them.
- Never re-enter a building to retrieve personal belongings once evacuation has begun.

4. Fire Extinguisher Selection

- Class A (wood, paper, textiles): water or foam extinguishers.
- Class B (flammable liquids, solvents, paints): foam, dry powder, or CO2 extinguishers.
- Class C (flammable gases): dry powder extinguishers, with gas supply isolated if safe to do so.
- Class D (combustible metals): specialized dry powder extinguishers only.
- Class E (electrical fires): CO2 or dry powder extinguishers only; water must never be used on live electrical equipment.

5. Fire Warden Responsibilities

Designated fire wardens for each zone must, upon hearing the alarm, direct occupants in their zone toward the nearest safe exit, check restrooms and enclosed spaces for stragglers, close fire doors, and report to the assembly point coordinator confirming their zone is clear. Fire wardens carry a high-visibility vest and a zone checklist during drills and actual events.

6. Evacuation Coordination

On activation of the fire alarm, all personnel must stop work immediately, power down equipment only if it can be done within seconds without risk, and proceed via the nearest marked emergency exit to the designated assembly point (see the Evacuation SOP for assembly point locations and headcount procedures). Lifts/elevators must never be used during a fire evacuation.

7. Notification of Emergency Services

The Security/Control Room must call the local fire brigade emergency number immediately upon alarm activation, providing the exact location, nature of the fire if known, and confirmation of whether all personnel are accounted for. The Site Emergency Coordinator meets emergency responders at the main gate to brief them and provide site plans.

8. Post-Incident Procedure

The affected area must not be re-entered until cleared by the fire brigade and the Site Emergency Coordinator. A full incident investigation is conducted within 48 hours, covering root cause, response effectiveness, and corrective actions. Fire extinguishers used during the event must be replaced or refilled immediately.

9. Training and Drills

Fire evacuation drills are conducted at least twice per year for all shifts, with results documented including evacuation time and any deficiencies observed. All employees receive basic fire extinguisher training during induction, and fire wardens receive advanced training including live fire extinguisher practice annually.